

Change Management Policy

Langate Group

Purpose

This policy establishes Langate Group's processes to manage changes across the organization in a well-communicated, planned, and predictable manner that minimizes unplanned outages and unforeseen system issues.

Roles and Responsibilities

- **IT Manager** is responsible for policy implementation (except Software Development part).
- **Project Manager** is responsible for the Software Development part of the policy.
- **ISMS manager** is responsible for updating, reviewing, and maintaining this policy.

Policy

This policy communicates Langate Group management's intent to implement IT-supported business processes in a way that minimizes risk and impact to Langate Group and its operations. Langate Group will manage all system and application changes subject to this policy (e.g., operating system, computing hardware, networks, applications, and data centers) in accordance with the applicable change management procedures.

Procedures

The objective of this process is to manage the introduction of any change into production by ensuring that the correct procedures are being followed, proper documentation has been completed, proper testing has been performed, and proper approval is in place.

Organizational Change Control

The following procedures apply to all changes, including infrastructure, code, and networking changes, as well as the deployment of new hardware:

- A record of agreed authorization levels will be maintained.
- Changes are only submitted by authorized users.
- Controls and integrity procedures will be reviewed to ensure that they will not be compromised by the changes.
- All software, information, database entities, and hardware that require amendment will be identified.
- Security-critical code to minimize the likelihood of known security weaknesses will be identified and checked.
- Formal approval must be obtained for detailed proposals before work begins.
- Authorized users must accept changes prior to implementation.
- Changes will be implemented at a time that is least intrusive to the business processes involved.
- Vendor-supplied software will be used without modification; in the event that a modification is necessary, the following will be evaluated:
 - Risk of compromising built-in controls and integrity processes
 - Vendor consent
 - Getting the modifications from the vendor as standard updates
 - Impact of owning the responsibility for maintaining the program

- Compatibility with other software in use.
- A technical review of applications will be conducted after changes to operating platforms (operating systems, databases, and middleware platforms). The review will include:
 - Application control and integrity procedures to ensure that they have not been compromised by the operating platform changes.
 - Timely notification of operating platform changes to allow appropriate tests and reviews to take place before implementation.
 - Appropriate changes are made to the business continuity plans.
- Customers must be notified of major changes (new subprocessor, etc.) or changes that may lead to system downtime at least two weeks prior to their deployment to the production environment.

Planned Changes

For planned changes, Langate Group will:

- Plan the implementation and assign tasks, responsibilities, deadlines, and resources;
- Implement changes according to the plan; and,
- Monitor the implementation to confirm that they are implemented according to the plan.

Unplanned Changes

For observed unintended changes, Langate Group will:

- Review consequences of the changes;
- Evaluate the occurrence or potential for occurrence of any adverse effects;
- Plan and implement actions to mitigate any adverse effects as necessary;
- In the case of Emergency Changes (e.g., when a critical vulnerability is discovered and needs to be resolved immediately), an expedited process may be conducted.

Software Development

For software development, operating system applications and software changes will only be implemented after extensive and successful testing:

- The tests will cover:
 - Usability
 - Security
 - Effects on other systems
 - User-friendliness
 - Tests will be conducted on separate systems (test environment), and all corresponding program source libraries will also be updated as appropriate.
- The operational software, applications, and program libraries of Langate Group will only be updated by trained administrators upon appropriate management authorization.
- Company operational systems will only hold approved executable code, not development code or compilers.
- A configuration control system will be used to keep control of all implemented software as well as the system documentation.
 - Previous versions of the software will be retained as a contingency measure.
 - Old versions of the software will be archived, together with all required information and parameters, procedures, configuration details, and supporting software, for as long as the data are retained in the archive.

- The utility programs of Langate Group will only be accessible to a minimum practical number of authorized users in conjunction with Langate Group's *System Access Control Policy*. The use of utility programs will require:
 - Use of identification, authentication, and authorization procedures;
 - Defining and documenting of authorization levels and ad-hoc use for utility programs;
 - Not making utility programs available to users who have access to applications on systems where segregation of duties is required;
 - Removing or disabling all unnecessary utility programs;
 - At a minimum, logical segregation of utility programs from application software. Where practical, segregating network communications for such programs from application traffic;
 - Limitation of the availability of utility programs (e.g., for the duration of an authorized change);
 - Logging of all use of utility programs.
- There will be a rollback strategy in place before changes are implemented.
- An audit log will be maintained of all updates to operational program libraries.
- All decisions to upgrade to a new version release must take into account:
 - Business requirements for the change
 - Security of the release, e.g., the introduction of new information security functionality or the number and severity of information security problems affecting this version.
- Change security measures will be in place to include:
 - Branch protection rules;
 - Review & approval from the security team in case of significant changes;
 - Changes deployed to production only by specifically authorized personnel with escalated privileges; and,
 - Post-deployment QA testing to ensure the change is functioning as intended in the production environment.

Supplier Services

Management of changes to supplier services is covered in the *Vendor Management Policy* in the Policy Center.

Configuration Management

For configuration management, production, and system network, changes will only be implemented with properly conducted procedures:

- No systems are deployed into Langate Group environments without prior approval from Langate Group management and the IT Manager.
- All changes to production systems, network devices, and firewalls are approved by the Langate Group management and IT Manager before they are implemented to ensure they comply with business and security requirements.
- All changes to production systems are tested before they are implemented in production.
- Implementation of approved changes is only performed by authorized personnel.
- Configuration changes are implemented with the use of scripts or manually by authorized personnel.
- All frontend functionality (developer dashboards and portals) is separated from backend (database and app servers) systems by being deployed on separate servers or containers.
- All software and systems are tested using unit tests and end-to-end tests.
- All committed code is reviewed using pull requests to assure software code quality and proactively detect potential security issues in development.
- Langate Group utilizes development and staging environments that mirror production to assure proper function.
- All formal change requests require a unique ID and authentication.
- Identities assigned to multiple persons (e.g., shared identities) are only permitted where they are necessary for business or operational reasons and are subject to dedicated approval and documentation.

- Clocks are continuously synchronized to an authoritative source across all systems using a single reference time source. Modifying time data on systems is restricted.

These procedures will be reflected in Langate Group's Configuration Change Management Plan (see Appendix A).

APPENDIX A

Langate Group Configuration Change Management Plan

1. Purpose

This plan outlines the process for managing configuration and system changes in a controlled and secure manner in compliance with ISO/IEC 27001. Its goal is to minimize the impact of change-related incidents and maintain the integrity, availability, and confidentiality of information systems.

2. Scope

This plan applies to all information systems, applications, and infrastructure components within the organization that store, process, or transmit sensitive information. It covers hardware, software, network configurations, and associated documentation.

3. Definitions

- **Configuration Item (CI):** Any component of an information system (e.g., hardware, software, documentation) that requires control and management.
- **Change Request (CR):** A formal proposal to modify a CI.

4. Configuration Items

- **Management:** Documentation describing the processes used to develop (or manage the development of) the system.
- **Technical:** Documentation describing the system (e.g., Functional Requirements Document).
- **Software:** Computer programs, operating systems, and support tools, etc.
- **Data & Database:** Files and records that exist apart from software, which access the contents of a database.
- **Network:** As applicable
- **Hardware:** Computer workstations, peripherals, servers, and routers, if applicable, etc.
- **Other:** Other components that management may wish to include at its discretion.

5. Roles & Responsibilities

- **Change Manager:** Oversees the change management process, ensures compliance, and maintains documentation.
- **System Owners:** Identify the need for changes and submit CRs.
- **IT Team:** Implements approved changes and conducts testing.
- **ISMS Manager:** Ensures changes align with ISO/IEC 27001 requirements.
- **Change Management Board (CMB):** The project-level decision-making body that must approve or reject all

change management requests before they can be implemented, with the composition determined by the ISMS Manager.

6. Change Control Process

6.1 Change Identification

System Owners identify the need for a change due to system updates, security patches, performance improvements, or other reasons.

Changes are categorized as:

- **Standard:** Pre-approved, low-risk changes (e.g., routine patches).
- **Normal:** Changes requiring formal review and approval.
- **Emergency:** Urgent changes to address critical issues (e.g., security vulnerabilities).

6.2 Change Request Submission

A Change Request Form is submitted by the System Owner, including:

- Description of the change.
- Affected CIs.
- Implementation plan.
- Testing requirements.

6.3 Risk Assessment

- The ISMS Manager evaluates the CR for:
 - Potential impact on confidentiality, integrity, and availability.
 - Compliance with ISO/IEC 27001 controls (e.g., A.12.5.1, A.14.2.2).
 - Alignment with organizational risk management policies.
- High-risk changes require additional controls or mitigation measures.

6.4 Review and Approval

The CMB reviews the CR, considering:

- Risk assessment results.
- Business justification.
- Resource requirements.

Approval is granted for low/medium-risk changes; high-risk changes may require TOP Management approval.

Emergency changes follow an expedited review process but must be documented post-implementation.

6.5 Implementation

IT Team:

- Implements approved changes from the CR.
- Tests changes to ensure functionality and security.
- Documents changes (e.g., system configurations, logs).

6.6 Testing and Validation

Post-implementation testing verifies:

- The change achieves its intended purpose.
- No adverse impact on system performance or security.
- Compliance with ISO/IEC 27001 controls.

Test results are documented and reviewed by the Change Manager.

6.7 Documentation and Reporting

All changes are recorded by the IT team together with the Change Manager in the Change Management Log, including:

- CR details.
- Approval status.
- Implementation and testing results.
- Lessons learned.

7. Emergency Change Procedures

Emergency changes bypass standard review but require:

- Immediate notification to the Change Manager and the ISMS Manager.
- Post-implementation review and documentation within 24 hours.
- Validation to ensure no residual security risks.

Policy version history

 Policy details

Policy name	Renewal date
Change Management Policy	April 13, 2027
Description	
This policy establishes the company's processes to manage changes across the organization in a well-communicated, planned and predictable manner that minimizes unplanned outages and unforeseen system issues.	

 Version history

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Explanation of changes					
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